

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 931

By McKenzie

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Lois Goins LeFlore on the celebration of her 100th birthday.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to pay tribute to those citizens who are celebrating special occasions in their estimable lives; and

WHEREAS, Lois Goins LeFlore celebrates her 100th birthday on February 23, 2026, a milestone commemorated as yet another precious souvenir of life's rich pageant; and

WHEREAS, born in Knoxville on February 23, 1926, Mrs. LeFlore has lived a remarkable life, having experienced firsthand the most eventful and productive years of American history; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. LeFlore was the third of four children born to Mr. and Mrs. Homer Goins, Sr., and she received her formal education in Knox County Schools; and

WHEREAS, Lois LeFlore attended Knoxville College, where she was honored as Miss Knoxville College in 1946 and initiated into the Pi Chapter of Zeta Phi Beta Sorority, Inc., before graduating with a Bachelor of Arts degree in 1947; and

WHEREAS, shortly after her college graduation, Mrs. LeFlore began her fruitful and fulfilling tenure as an educator in the Knoxville school system, a profession she dearly loved; and

WHEREAS, following the integration of the University of Tennessee, Lois LeFlore earned her Master of Science degree and went on to devote thirty-one years of service as a Knox County Schools teacher; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. LeFlore took her much-deserved retirement from Knox County Schools and was selected as the first instructor for the Knoxville College campus's Job Corps program, a role she was proud to hold for ten years; and

WHEREAS, throughout her professional career, Lois LeFlore was wholly committed to the growth and development of young people; she was a leader in her field and her community, and she was chosen to serve as camp director of the City-Wide Girl Scouts and as director of the Law Cadets; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. LeFlore accepted Christ at a young age and united with First Calvary Baptist Church, where she remains a faithful member today; she has served her church in several capacities throughout the years, including as a Sunday School teacher and as superintendent of the youth department; and

WHEREAS, deeply devoted to her family, Lois LeFlore was joined in holy matrimony with her college sweetheart, Robert "Bob" LeFlore, in 1948, with whom she enjoyed fifty-eight years of marriage until his passing; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. LeFlore is the proud mother of Melvenia; grandmother of Jerry Jr. and Jameela; and great-grandmother of Jaliyah, Jerry III, Jace, and Jaya; and

WHEREAS, Lois LeFlore has been and continues to be an inspiration to all who have the good fortune of knowing her; she is ever supportive, encouraging, and steadfast in her faith, and her spiritual guidance and dedication to family, church, and community are immeasurable; and

WHEREAS, we wish to grasp this opportunity to specially recognize one of Tennessee's most outstanding citizens on this very special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Lois Goins LeFlore on the celebration of her 100th birthday and extend to her our best wishes for much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.